

JAIPUR | Reverse Snubbery

Former chief minister Vasundhara Raje and her party colleagues' boycotted a gathering hosted by Governor S.K. Singh on Republic Day. The boycott was an apparent snub to Singh who had charged the Raje government with corruption in his inaugural address to the Assembly earlier this month. Later, he had rejected several bills after they had been approved by Raje's government. The rejected bills included a reservation quota for the economically backward and a special quota for Gurjars. The immediate provocation for the boycott, though, may be the fact that Chief Minister Ashok Gehlot set up a commission headed by a former Rajasthan High Court judge to probe charges of corruption, especially involving land deals, against the Raje government. The BJP claims that this move is a vendetta against Raje, who had cancelled a land allotment to Gehlot's father on the grounds of failure to pay. Gehlot is

RAJE



gearing up to portray the Congress as a "clean" party and the BJP as "corrupt" before the Assembly polls. In the past, most chief ministers and leaders of the Opposition had worked together. Not any longer.

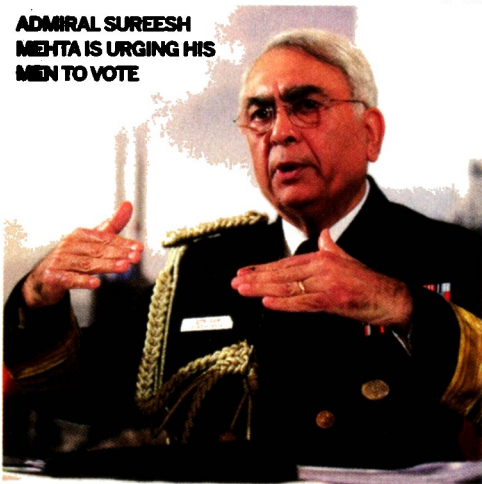
by Rohit Parihar

In and Out

After CPI's A.B. Bardhan moved out of his party HQ at Ajoy Bhavan, comrades in Big Bro CPI(M) say that Prakash Karat is in reverse migration, moving out of a relative's house in Greater Kailash to the Marxist barracks that is Vithalbhai Patel House.

PRAVEEN NEGI

ADMIRAL SURESH MEHTA IS URGING HIS MEN TO VOTE



DELHI | Military Vote

The itinerant nature of India's million-man strong armed forces ensures they are never in any single constituency long enough to vote. While the Election Commission is trying to popularise proxy voting for soldiers and postal ballots, the navy has sent out reminders to all its personnel in Delhi with relevant forms urging them to get themselves registered in electoral rolls to vote in the upcoming Lok Sabha polls. The army and air force are believed to follow suit.

by Sandeep Unnithan

PATNA | Copping Out

Delay is often the middle name of bureaucracy. This time it has made the men in khaki from Bihar miss the coveted President medals when men from other state forces received the awards with due ceremony on Republic Day. The Ministry of Home Affairs refused to consider the Bihar list because it reached the Centre three days after the all-India list of

BIHAR COPS WERE DENIED MEDALS ON REPUBLIC DAY



awardees was cleared. Two names had been recommended for the President's Police Medal for Distinguished Services and 18 for Police Medal for Meritorious Services. This is not the first time Bihar cops have been left out. In 2003 and 2006, they were denied the medals on similar grounds.

by Amitabh Srivastava